



Aex Meridian Business Plan (Revised with AI Content Services)

Aex Meridian remains a solo-operated Colorado LLC focused on empowering small businesses online. The **core mission** stays the same: provide premium-quality websites and digital marketing that small firms couldn't build or afford on their own. We **expand** the original plan by adding AI-driven digital content creation – notably short video walkthroughs for realtors and Airbnb hosts, plus social-media posts – delivered at affordable rates. This leverages cutting-edge AI tools so even non-technical business owners can get professional videos and posts. The updated offering keeps pricing low (far below large agencies) by using AI automation, while maintaining the founder's one-person model.

Services & Pricing

- **AI-Designed Websites:** As before, we build a complete mobile-friendly site for each client using **Astro** and Claude Code (AI-assisted development). *Pricing:* One-time setup fee **\$500-\$750** (introductory rate) and ongoing hosting/maintenance **\$35/month**. This includes hosting, updates, security, and minor edits, with clients never touching the CMS – we do all updates on their behalf.
- **AI-Generated Walkthrough Videos (Realtor/Airbnb Listings):** Using AI video generators, we create polished listing tours with voiceovers, music, and text overlays. For example, tools like **Pictory** can turn listing descriptions and images into a short video in minutes [3†L260-L268] , and platforms like **Promo.com** will “paste your Airbnb listing URL... and the AI will take care of the rest,” producing a ready-to-use video highlighting property features [28†L398-L406] [8†L374-L382] . We offer these videos as one-time projects or bundled packages. Pricing is **per video**, starting around **\$50-\$100** for a basic 60–90 second tour, up to ~\$150 for a premium version with custom branding and multiple formats. (By contrast, agencies often charge hundreds or thousands for a single listing video.) For context, an industry blog suggests selling listing video packages (video + photos + posts) in the \$300–500 range [13†L231-L239] ; our focus on AI lets us undercut that significantly.
- **AI-Driven Social Media Content:** We also produce ongoing social-media assets (graphics, short clips, and post text). Using AI tools (e.g. **Canva's Magic Media** to auto-generate imagery, **CapCut** for quick Reel creation, **Synthesia** or **InVideo** for script-to-video posts), we assemble content calendars for clients. For example, CapCut's AI features (auto-captions, teleprompter) make 15–30 second reels fast to produce [4†L138-L146] , and Canva's AI can even create B-roll clips (e.g. a park scene) when live footage is missing [4†L133-L139] . **Pricing:** We offer monthly “content retainer” packages (e.g. 3–5 branded posts/videos per month) in the **\$100-\$300/month** range, depending on volume. (This is far below typical agency rates, as PhotoAIVideo reports small packages starting around \$299 [13†L231-L239] .)

All prices are introductory, reflecting our early-stage portfolio. As our track record grows, we plan to raise rates modestly (per Section 6.2 triggers in the original plan) while continuing to bundle value. Importantly,

website maintenance (\$35/mo) remains separate – content creation is billed on top (either one-off or subscription), so heavy content requests do not cannibalize the web hosting margin.

AI Tools & Production Workflow

We leverage modern AI video engines to maximize efficiency. For **walkthrough videos**, example tools include:

- **Pictory** (turns text & images into video scenes [3†L260-L268]), **Animoto** (quick photo slideshow videos) [3†L368-L377] , **InVideo** (script-to-video with stock clips) [4†L150-L159] , **Runway ML** for advanced editing (if needed), and **Promo.com** for one-click listing videos [28†L398-L406] . Platforms like **Vmake** use an AI “video agent” that conversationally crafts a property script and edits footage [4†L85-L94] . For Airbnb/short-term rentals, Promo’s AI tool is ideal: hosts “simply paste the link to your Airbnb listing... and the AI will take care of the rest” [28†L398-L406] , producing a finished marketing video within minutes.
- For **social media posts**, we use AI tools to batch-generate content. For instance, **Canva Magic Media** can quickly make branded graphics or simulate video clips of local landmarks [4†L133-L139] . **CapCut** app helps produce TikTok/Reel videos in seconds with auto-captions and an AI teleprompter [4†L138-L146] . Voiceovers and captions are AI-generated as needed, ensuring clients get publish-ready content without expertise.

Workflow: (1) Gather client info – property photos, key points, branding. (2) Use an AI video generator (e.g. Paste listing into Promo or feed text into Pictory) to create a draft video. (3) Review internally – check for brand consistency and accuracy. (4) Finalize edits, then deliver to client. For social content, we schedule posts using AI-enhanced tools (auto-captioning, hashtag suggestions). All deliverables come with our logo and contact info to build our brand. This AI-powered process means a professional-looking video or graphic can be produced in minutes rather than days [8†L374-L382] [3†L260-L268] .

Market Demand & Target Clients

The demand is strong for inexpensive, high-quality digital content. Today’s consumers overwhelmingly prefer video: **85% of people say video convinced them to buy a product or service**, and **84% want to see more online videos from brands** [30†L109-L114] . Small businesses know they need video to compete, but production used to be costly and time-consuming. AI has changed that. By 2026, many marketers report video is **becoming as cheap or cheaper to make** than before [30†L137-L144] , yet 82% still see **great ROI from video** [30†L147-L150] .

Our **target clients** remain local small businesses with minimal online presence, expanded to emphasize:

- **Realtors and Property Managers** (for home listing tours). These professionals rely on visual marketing but often lack in-house media staff. An AI video can make a listing stand out on sites and social media, helping it sell faster. (Research shows listings with video “stand out, attract attention, and drive more bookings” in competitive markets [28†L402-L410] .)
- **Short-Term Rental Hosts (Airbnb, VRBO)**. A polished walkthrough video significantly boosts guest interest. With AI, hosts can get a professional video *fast*: “With the right AI tools, you can create a professional Airbnb video in ten minutes or less” without a crew [8†L374-L382] .

- **Other Local SMEs** (e.g. small retail, hospitality or service businesses) who can use social-media content to engage local audiences. The goal is any business that values online visibility but can't afford large agencies. Our process often finds them via "cold outreach" (e.g. showing a sample website or video first) and word-of-mouth referrals.

Geographically, we continue focusing on Highlands Ranch, CO and Spokane, WA areas – communities with vibrant small-business scenes and many realtors and hosts. In those markets, we can become known for offering combined web+video services tailored to local needs.

Sales & Client Acquisition

We maintain the **speculative-build sales model** from the original plan: build a demo (website or sample video) first, then pitch it. For example, a targeted Realtor might receive an unsolicited sample home tour video with our contact info. Such "finished-product outreach" dramatically raises response rates. When pitching, we lead with the differentiator: **"I already built this for you – take a look."** This has worked well for websites, and equally applies to video content.

In addition, we will market the new services via: local networking events (e.g. real estate meetups, host clubs), and social media. We'll use our own branding to showcase expertise (posting mini case studies and before/after content). Pricing remains **transparent and modest** to pull in clients who balk at agency quotes. For example, rather than charging an agent \$1,000+ for a listing video, we'll offer it for under \$200, emphasizing the value (\$35-\$100 profit per job after tool costs 【13†L242-L250】). Over time, satisfied clients and testimonials will further boost credibility (triggering the price increases outlined in Section 6.2 of the original plan).

Technology & Operations

Our **tech stack** for websites stays as planned: Astro framework, Claude Code AI dev, GitHub for repos, and (recommended) Cloudflare Pages hosting. We add tools for content creation: e.g. a subscription to a service like PhotoAI or Promo (roughly \$30/mo) to handle unlimited video projects. We also equip the founder with a modern laptop and smartphone for capturing any needed footage.

Workflow Integration: The operations remain lean and solo-driven. In practice, the founder will schedule days for website builds and days for content production. For example, after identifying a new client, the founder might spend a morning building the demo site and afternoon generating the demo video. Each client file (repo, content folders) includes a section tracking content orders and deadlines. For maintenance, the monthly fee continues covering only the website; any new video or graphics orders are handled as separate tasks.

Roles: One person (the founder) still wears all hats. Sales calls and outreach now include demonstrating sample videos. Content creation is done by the founder alone, using the AI "assistants." We deliberately limit new client volume so that one person can handle both the original web work *and* the extra video/content without burnout. Only if demand grows very large (e.g. multi-day backlog) would we consider subcontracting basic editing or hiring a VA to manage scheduling.

Payments & Contracts: Payment processing (U.S. Bank merchant services) covers all fees. Contracts and invoices will clearly **itemize** website vs. content services. The monthly \$35 maintenance contract remains unchanged; any video or social-media package is scoped and billed separately (either one-time or as a short-term “add-on retainer”). The scope document for videos will specify length, number of revisions, and formats (HD + mobile version, etc.). Ownership remains straightforward: the client owns final videos/photos; we retain project files and AI outputs only as needed for our portfolio. We will ensure no deliverable is published without written client sign-off (same rule as for websites).

Marketing, Sales & Financial Projections

Marketing Strategies: Alongside direct outreach, we will publish our own content showing results. For instance, we could share an anonymized before/after listing video on LinkedIn or local forums, with caption “See how we turned these listing pics into a video tour!” Search ads targeting “realtor listing video cheap” may be considered. We’ll also offer **referral discounts**: a realtor who sends another agent our way gets a bonus (or discounted next project).

Revenue Expectations: Even a small client base yields revenue. For example, 10 clients in Year 1 each paying a \$600 site setup + \$420/year (\$35×12) yields ~\$10,200 from websites. If 5 of those also buy a \$100 video, that’s \$500 extra. In Year 2, aiming for 15–20 clients, plus 10–15 videos, and a few ongoing content contracts (\$100/mo each) could double revenue. Importantly, content margins are high: if we spend ~\$2 in tool cost per \$100 video 【13†L242-L250】 , most of that fee is profit.

The **break-even** point (originally targeting 5+ clients) now includes content income. Even at launch pricing, one or two large video orders could cover fixed costs. For instance, a single \$299 content bundle sale (video+photos+posts) already exceeds our initial break-even target. Over 12 months, the combination of site fees and content fees should keep our cash flow positive. As case studies accumulate, we will raise prices (per Section 6.2) to increase monthly recurring revenue. We continue basic bookkeeping and one-person payroll; no major capital outlays are needed beyond AI subscriptions (covered by income).

Risks & Mitigations

- *Time Investment for Unpaid Work:* Creating speculative videos costs time. We mitigate by using reusable templates and batching similar projects (e.g. similar home types) to speed up each build, as originally planned. Even unsold demo videos become portfolio pieces.
- *Scope Creep:* Clients may request extra edits or posts beyond the package. We define clear scope (e.g. 1 free revision per video) and bill out-of-scope requests. Clients can upgrade to a higher tier if needed.
- *Tool Limitations:* AI video generators aren’t perfect (e.g. they may mispronounce words or cut off clips awkwardly). We always review and manually tweak outputs. Using high-quality input (good photos and accurate text) reduces errors.
- *Market Education:* Some clients may not immediately see the value of AI content. We address this by showing stats (e.g. “85% of guests say video convinced them to book” 【8†L374-L382】) during pitches and by offering trial clips.
- *Founder Capacity:* Juggling sites and videos could strain one person. We’ve sized pricing/scope so one person can handle X clients per month. If business scales beyond that, we will either outsource repetitive editing tasks or raise prices to limit volume (only taking on what we can manage).

Overall, adding AI-powered content creation complements our existing web design business. It opens new revenue streams with minimal incremental cost (just time and a few tool subscriptions) and meets a clear market need. With these services, Aex Meridian can offer small businesses an all-in-one affordable digital presence: a live website plus eye-catching video and social content – all delivered with AI-efficiency at “solo-operator” pricing. 【28†L398-L406】 【30†L109-L114】

Sources: AI video tool capabilities and pricing insights 【3†L260-L268】 【4†L133-L142】 【8†L374-L382】 【13†L231-L239】 【28†L398-L406】 【30†L109-L114】 have been incorporated to inform these strategy and pricing recommendations.
